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## President to begin state visit to Germany

ABU DHABI

President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan will begin a state visit to the Federal Republic of Germany tomorrow.

During the visit, Sheikh Mohamed will meet with German President Frank-Walter Steinmeier and German Chancellor Friedrich Merz to discuss the strong and enduring ties between the two countries and explore opportunities to deepen cooperation, particularly in the economic and development sectors, in support of their shared interests.

The discussions will take place within the framework of the strategic partnership between the UAE and Germany.

The talks will also address regional and international developments and issues of mutual concern.

### Strategic partnership

Diplomatic relations between the two countries were established in 1972 and have since witnessed significant developments, culminating in the declaration of a strategic partnership in 2004.

Mutual visits between the leaders and officials of the two countries have helped strengthen consultation and coordination on bilateral, regional and international issues and open new avenues for cooperation.

— WAM

SEE ALSO P-1

## Dubai launches ‘Click and Travel’ service to speed up airport checks

SYSTEM USES BIOMETRICS AND FACIAL RECOGNITION TO REDUCE WAITING TIMES

DUBAI

BY AGHADDIR ALI  
Senior Reporter

The General Directorate of Identity and Foreigners Affairs (GDRFA) Dubai has officially launched its “Click and Travel” service, allowing passport officers to complete passengers’ entry and departure procedures using mobile devices and process each transaction in approximately 12 to 15 seconds.

The announcement was made during a press conference held at Dubai International Airport yesterday, attended by Lieutenant General Mohammed Ahmed Al Marri, Director General of GDRFA Dubai, and Major General Talal Ahmed Al Shanqiti, Assistant Director General for Airport Affairs in addition to senior officials.

The new service is designed to accelerate immigration procedures and improve the efficiency of passenger processing, particularly during peak travel seasons, periods of congestion and emergencies.

### Automated pre-screening

GDRFA Dubai said the service combines biometric fingerprint technology, facial recognition and electronic passport reading, along with automated pre-screening and instant access to passenger information through a secure communications network.

During its pilot phase, “Click and Travel” processed the immigration procedures of 31,373 passengers between its experimental launch in May 2026 and



Virendra Saklani/Gulf News

■ The mobile system allows passport officers to move through airport halls and process passengers away from fixed counters.

the end of August. The pilot phase was used to test the service’s efficiency and prepare for its wider deployment across the different terminals of Dubai’s airports.

Unlike traditional immigration processing, the mobile system allows passport officers to move through airport halls and process passengers away from fixed counters.

This provides greater flexibility for airport teams to manage passenger movements and regulate passenger flows, particularly during periods of high demand.

The project went through

several stages of development. The first pilot phase began in October 2025, when the service was activated for passengers at Terminal 3 of Dubai International Airport.

### All passenger categories

In May 2026, the second pilot phase expanded the service to all passenger categories across Dubai’s airport terminals. Following the successful pilot and expansion phases, GDRFA Dubai announced the service’s official launch yesterday.

The “Click and Travel” service is available to UAE citizens, residents, GCC nationals and

visitors, supporting Dubai’s efforts to expand the use of smart solutions and advanced technologies across its airports.

The initiative reflects Dubai’s continued focus on using digital and biometric technologies to streamline government procedures, improve operational efficiency and enhance the passenger experience. The mobile service also gives immigration teams greater operational flexibility, enabling them to respond quickly to changes in passenger volumes and manage congestion more effectively during peak periods and emergencies.

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## Gargash says rebuilding trust with Iran could take decades

Iran’s attacks on UAE, other GCC countries were premeditated, UAE official says

DUBAI

BY KHITAM AL AMIR  
Chief News Editor

Iran’s attacks on the UAE and other Gulf countries were premeditated and planned rather than an impulsive response, and rebuilding the trust destroyed by the conflict could take decades, a senior UAE official said.

Dr Anwar Gargash, Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President, said engagement with Iran remained a central issue for the UAE and its Gulf neighbours because geography left them with little choice but to maintain communication.

### Clear distinction

Speaking at the Hili Forum 2026 in Abu Dhabi, Gargash, however, drew a clear distinction between restoring a necessary working relationship with Tehran and rebuilding trust.

Iran’s attacks involving thou-



**Iran destroyed the bridges of communication that had been built over decades with the Gulf. While a practical relationship can and ultimately must be restored, rebuilding trust is something entirely different.”**

Dr Anwar Gargash

| Diplomatic Adviser to the UAE President

sands of missiles and drones against the UAE and other countries constituted a “war of choice”, deliberately planned against neighbours that had not attacked it, Gargash said.

He described the attacks as a flagrant violation of international law and a profound failure of statecraft. “Iran destroyed the bridges of communication that had been built over decades with the Gulf,” Gargash said, adding: “While a practical relationship can and ultimately must be restored,

rebuilding trust is something entirely different.”

He said the assumption of good faith that had underpinned much of the Gulf’s engagement with Iran had been “destroyed within hours” and could take years, perhaps decades, to rebuild.

### Gulf response fell short

Gargash also offered a critical assessment of the regional and international response to the crisis, which widened from the war in Gaza, saying it had proved ineffective in preventing threats or protecting energy flows and maritime navigation.

He said individual Gulf countries had demonstrated strength and resolve in responding to Iranian attacks, but that national effectiveness had not translated into a sufficiently strong collective regional response. The GCC countries broadly agreed on the nature of the challenge posed by Iran, he said, but had fallen short in confronting the structural threat and translating that common understanding into a sufficiently unified and strategic response.

SEE ALSO P10

## Harry Potter lands at Warner Bros. World Abu Dhabi

From Diagon Alley to Hogwarts, find out what is confirmed

DUBAI

BY LAKSHANA N. PALAT  
Assistant Features Editor

Miral and Warner Bros. Discovery Global Experiences have confirmed what Potterheads across the region have been not-so-quietly hoping for: Three full-scale Harry Potter lands are coming to Warner Bros. World Abu Dhabi. That means Diagon Alley, Hogwarts, and the Forbidden Forest, spread across a genuinely enormous 63,000 square metres, that’s roughly 678,000 square feet of wizarding world, built from scratch, in the desert.

Here is what is actually confirmed.

### ■ Diagon Alley: Your shopping list time

Every great Potter story starts with a trip down Diagon Alley, and now fans in the region won’t have to imagine cobbled streets and crooked shopfronts from behind a screen. Wand shops, wizarding storefronts, and the kind of immersive detail that makes you forget you’re not actually eleven years old and terrified of Gringotts goblins.

### ■ Hogwarts, obviously

No wizarding world is complete without the castle itself. Hogwarts is officially joining the lineup, promising all the creeps and fun, that you can expect from the castle.

### ■ The Forbidden Forest: Slightly less safe, but just so exciting

And then there’s the Forbidden Forest, the land nobody was told they needed until right now. It’s dark, atmospheric, packed with things lurking out of sight (who is imagining a centaur spotting?)

### When can you actually go?

Construction is targeted for completion in 2028. For a project of this scale, being one of the first parks in the world to bring Hogwarts and Diagon Alley together under one roof, it is worth the wait.

Simon Robinson, President Global Experiences & Studio Operations, Warner Bros. Discovery, had earlier said, “The expansion of Warner Bros. World Abu Dhabi represents a significant step forward in our

commitment to building world-class destinations anchored in the strength of our storytelling.”

The reveal had earlier opened with the flying Ford Anglia, the enchanted car from *Harry Potter and the Chamber of Secrets*.

This will be the first permanent Harry Potter attraction built outside a Universal-operated park, and the first anywhere in the Middle East. Like the rest of Warner Bros. World, it will be fully indoor and air-conditioned, a built-in advantage against Abu Dhabi’s climate.

